SEO Changelog — Is Crab Island Safe for Families?

URL: https://bikkinibottomboat.com/is-crab-island-safe-for-families/ · **WP ID:** 2381 (Elementor, HTML in Text Editor) · **Audit date:** 2026-10-25 · **Audit page 12 of 24**
Sources: WordPress/Elementor content and Rank Math fields (site connector), Semrush US keyword volumes. Semrush has no ranking data for this URL.

1. Summary

Area	Current state	Priority
Search demand	Small but high-trust: "is crab island kid friendly" 50, "crab island deaths" 30, "is crab island safe" 20, "crab island drowning" 20, "is crab island family friendly" 20, "crab island with kids" 20 (all KD 0–9). Parents researching safety are close to booking.	—
One-sided answer	The page says "yes" and covers only upsides. People searching "deaths" or "drowning" want an honest look at the risks: the channel current, boat traffic, alcohol around the sandbar, heat, sudden storms and depth changes with the tide. Google weights safety content for trustworthiness, so an honest "safe if..." answer will rank and convert better than a sales pitch.	**High**
No H1 / Rank Math	Starts with an H2; SEO title, meta and focus keyword all empty.	**High**
Party-boat question	It never says whether public tours mix families with bachelorette or party groups. Parents will wonder. [Owner: is there a family-friendly departure, or a policy on behavior?]	**Medium**
Missing specifics	No infant/toddler lifejacket sizes, no captain credentials (USCG license), no departure address or parking, no "what if weather turns" policy.	**Medium**
Consistency	"Bikkini Bottom provides a cooler onboard" (same cooler question as page 11).	**Low**
No CTA	Homepage link only.	**High**
Images / links	IMG_8973 alt is the page title. IMG-0277 alt says "Fort Walton Beach" and "Beach Please". Infographic PNG. Self-link (5th item). YouTube 560×435.	**Low**

2. Keyword targeting

Keyword	Vol.	KD	Use
is crab island kid friendly	50	9	**Primary**: title
is crab island safe / is crab island family friendly	20 / 20	0	H1 + intro
crab island with kids	20	0	H2 "Tips for Crab Island with Kids"

crab island deaths / crab island drowning	30 / 20	0	H2 "Real Risks at Crab Island (and How to Avoid Them)". Factual and calm; no invented statistics.

3. Rank Math / meta changes

Field	Current	Change to
SEO title	(empty)	**Is Crab Island Kid Friendly? Safety Tips for Families** (52)
Meta description	(empty)	**Yes, with the right plan. Shallow water, lifejackets and a licensed captain make Crab Island family-friendly. Here are the real risks and how to avoid them.** (155)
Focus keyword	(empty)	**is crab island kid friendly**; secondary: is crab island safe, crab island with kids
Slug	is-crab-island-safe-for-families	Keep
OG image	None	Kids in lifejackets in shallow water (IMG_8973 crop)

4. Heading structure

Tag	Current	New
H1	**missing** (H2 "Is Crab Island Safe for Kids and Families?")	**Is Crab Island Safe for Kids and Families?** (tag → H1)
H2	Why Crab Island Works So Well for Families	Keep
H2 (new)	—	**Real Risks at Crab Island (and How to Avoid Them)**, with H3s per risk
H2	How Bikkini Bottom Keeps Safety Simple	Keep, adding captain license and kids' lifejacket sizes
H2	Public Tour or Private Charter for Families?	Keep; add the party-group note + Tiki option
H2	Tips for a Safe Family Day at Crab Island	**Tips for Crab Island with Kids**; 6 bold items → H3
H2	What Age Is Right for Crab Island?	Keep
H2	Getting Your Family to the Dock in Destin	Keep; add address + parking
H2	Why Families Keep Choosing Bikkini Bottom	Keep + CTA
H2	Frequently Asked Questions About Crab Island and Families	Keep; questions → H3 + 2 new

5. Content rewrites & additions

(Intro, replace "Short answer: yes..." with:) **Short answer: yes, Crab Island is kid-friendly when you go with a plan.** The water is mostly 1–4 feet deep and calm, and on a captained tour you get lifejackets, a restroom and someone watching the weather. Like any open water, it has real risks: boat traffic, the current in the nearby channel, sun and crowds. Here's what to know so your family has a safe, fun day.

H2 Real Risks at Crab Island (and How to Avoid Them)

H3 Strong current in the channel

The sandbar is shallow, but the East Pass channel beside it is deep with a strong tidal current. Keep kids on the sandbar side of the boat and never let anyone swim toward the channel or the bridge.

H3 Boat traffic

Hundreds of boats come and go on busy days. Set a clear boundary around your boat and keep little ones away from where boats are anchoring or leaving.

H3 Changing depth with the tide

Water that's knee-deep at low tide can be chest-deep a few hours later, and there are drop-offs at the edges of the sandbar. Lifejackets on non-swimmers at all times.

H3 Sun and heat

Reflection off the water doubles your exposure. Reapply sunscreen every 80 minutes, keep kids drinking water and take shade breaks on the boat.

H3 Afternoon storms

Summer thunderstorms can build quickly over the Gulf. Our captain watches radar and heads in early if lightning threatens, and we'll contact you about any changes. [Owner: link the weather/cancellation policy.]

H3 Alcohol around the sandbar

Crab Island has a party side, especially on summer weekends. Mornings and weekdays are calmer, and with a captain driving your boat, nobody in your group needs to drive after drinking.

H2 How Bikkini Bottom Keeps Safety Simple

(Keep the existing text; add:) Every trip is run by a **USCG-licensed captain** [owner: confirm license type], and we carry lifejackets in [adult, youth, child and infant] sizes. Boarding at the marina is a level walk-on, and the restroom onboard means no frantic searching for a bathroom.

H2 Public Tour or Private Charter for Families?

(Keep the existing text; add:) Public tours can include adult groups celebrating, so if you'd rather keep things kid-centered, book a [morning departure] or a private trip. For families of up to 18, our sister company's private tiki boat is a smaller, budget-friendlier private option. Compare all the ways to get to Crab Island.

H2 Getting Your Family to the Dock in Destin

(Keep the existing text; add:) We depart from **530 Harbor Blvd, Destin**. Free parking is across Highway 98 at Craft Bar; with little ones, drop the family and gear at the dock first, then park. Directions and parking.

H2 Why Families Keep Choosing Bikkini Bottom

(Keep, then:) **[Book a Family Crab Island Tour]** Pack smart with our Crab Island packing list (including a kids' section).

H2 Frequently Asked Questions About Crab Island and Families

(6 existing as H3; fix the cooler wording; add:)

H3 Have people drowned at Crab Island?

Serious incidents are rare, but they have happened, usually involving swimmers who drift into the channel's current or boaters impaired by alcohol. Stay on the sandbar, wear lifejackets if you're not a strong swimmer, and go with a sober, licensed captain. [Owner: review wording.]

H3 Do you have lifejackets for babies and toddlers?

[Owner: e.g. "Yes, infant and child lifejackets are onboard. Let us know your kids' ages when you book."]

6. Internal linking

Anchor	Target	Note
Book a Family Crab Island Tour	/crab-island-tours-in-destin-fl/ (or FareHarbor 615407)	**new**
Bikkini Bottom Boat Charters (intro, existing → homepage)	change to /crab-island-tours-in-destin-fl/ with anchor "Crab Island tour"	change
private tiki boat	Crab Island Tiki Tours site	new
Compare all the ways to get to Crab Island	/crab-island-shuttle-vs-pontoon-rental-vs-charter/	new
Directions and parking	/contact-bikkini-bottom-boat-charters/	new
Crab Island packing list	/what-to-bring-to-crab-island/ (#kids section)	new
Destin dolphin cruise (in "What age": an easy first boat trip for toddlers)	/destin-dolphin-cruise/	new
Self-link in list	this page	**remove**

Inbound	this page	From the FAQ "family-friendly", the Crab Island page FAQ "How deep...", What is Crab Island FAQ "good for families", and the dolphin page "good for kids". ILJ: crab island with kids, kid friendly.

7. Technical fixes

Issue	Fix	Priority
H1 + Rank Math	First heading → H1; fill title, meta, focus keyword.	**High**
Bold tips → H3	Rebuild the tips as H3s or an Icon List.	**Medium**
Images	IMG_8973 alt → **"Kids in lifejackets playing in shallow water at Crab Island, Destin"**. IMG-0277 → **"Family group on a Crab Island tour aboard Bikkini Bottom in Destin"**. Infographic → WebP + caption.	**Low**
YouTube	Lazy Video widget, 16:9.	**Low**
Author / reviewer	Add a short "Reviewed by Captain [Daniel], USCG-licensed captain" line under the H1, plus an author box. Safety content needs a named expert (E-E-A-T).	**Medium**
Schema	Article with `reviewedBy` (Person: captain name, jobTitle "USCG-licensed captain") + FAQPage + Breadcrumb.	**Medium**

8. Tracking

Item	Setup
Family CTA	`begin_checkout` with `link_location` = family_page.
Sister-brand clicks	`sister_brand_click` (Tiki Tours).
Engagement on the risk section	Scroll and time-on-page. If readers stall at the risk section without booking, tighten the reassurance copy right after it.
Rank tracking	is crab island kid friendly, is crab island safe, crab island with kids, crab island drowning.

9. Changelog (implementation checklist)

#	Change	Where	Status
1	H1 tag; SEO title, meta, focus keyword	Elementor / Rank Math	To do
2	New intro ("safe with a plan")	Elementor	To do
3	**New H2 "Real Risks at Crab Island" with 6 H3s**	Elementor	To do

4	Captain license + lifejacket sizes; party-group note; Tiki option; address/parking	Elementor	To do
5	Tips → H3s; FAQ → H3s + 2 new	Elementor	To do
6	CTA + 7 internal links; self-link removed	Elementor	To do
7	Reviewed-by-captain line + author box	Elementor	To do
8	Alt text ×2; infographic + video fixes	Media	To do
9	Article (reviewedBy) + FAQPage + Breadcrumb schema	Rank Math	To do
10	Tracking + rank tracking	GTM / Semrush	To do
11	Owner: captain license type, lifejacket sizes, family-friendly departures, weather policy, drowning-FAQ wording, cooler	Owner	Waiting

Next page in queue: **Best Crab Island Tour for Bachelorette Parties & Large Groups** (ID 2389).